ROALLA



EXECUTIVE GROWTH LEADERSHIP DECISION GUIDE

Executive Decision Rights and Accountability Design

Make important decisions at the right level with evidence speed challenge and follow through

Prepared for founders, owners, boards, chief executives, investors and functional leaders in growth companies

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Purpose

This guide helps leadership teams identify material recurring decisions and assign clear authority, input, challenge, escalation and accountability. It moves beyond organization charts to the practical system through which strategy, investment, risk and operations are governed.

EXECUTIVE DECISION DASHBOARD

Management View at a Glance

Accountability becomes real when leaders know which decisions they own, what evidence is required, who must contribute and when escalation applies. Clear decision rights improve speed without sacrificing challenge or control.

Executive question	ROALLA view	Decision implication
Does RACI alone solve decision rights?	**NO**	It helps clarify roles but decisions also require criteria, forums, evidence and escalation.
Should every decision be documented?	**NO**	Focus on material, recurring or difficult-to-reverse choices.
Does consultation mean consensus?	**NO**	The accountable owner considers input and then decides.
Can authority be delegated without limits?	**NO**	Guardrails and escalation thresholds protect enterprise risk.
What should management authorize now?	**PURSUE**	A decision inventory and redesign of the highest-friction decisions.

Recommended Management Posture

Use the decision model to convert management confidence into verified evidence, explicit ownership and sequenced action. A weighted score supports prioritization, but a material hard-gate failure should override an attractive average.

Questions to Put to the Leadership Team

1. Which five decisions create the most delay or rework?
2. Who has final authority for each?
3. What evidence is necessary and sufficient?
4. Which roles provide input but not approval?
5. What thresholds require escalation?
6. Which forum is accountable for making the choice?
7. How are actions and outcomes tracked?
8. What recent reversal reveals a design problem?

EXECUTIVE DECISION MODEL

The Eight Decision Rights Gates

These gates distinguish a needed executive accountability from an attractive title. Use them to test mandate, authority, capacity, interfaces and evolution before recruiting or reorganizing.

Stage	Gate	Required conclusion	Decision evidence
01	Decisions	Material recurring choices are identified	Strategy, capital, people, product, risk and operations
02	Owner	One role has final accountability	Named decision authority and outcome owner
03	Inputs	Required expertise is defined	Data, finance, customer, technology, people and risk
04	Criteria	Trade-offs use explicit standards	Value, cost, capacity, risk, reversibility and timing
05	Forum	The decision is made in the right place	Purpose, membership, quorum and pre-reads
06	Escalation	Exceptions move predictably	Thresholds, urgency, conflict and deadlock
07	Record	Rationale and commitments are preserved	Decision, evidence, owner, actions and review
08	Review	Decision quality improves over time	Outcomes, reversals, delays and lessons

Decision Rule

A failed hard gate moves the initiative to Prepare or Monitor. A strong narrative, senior sponsor or attractive market cannot replace missing authority, evidence, delivery capacity or operating control.

SECTION 01

Readiness Framework

Translate ambition into a shared executive view of value, evidence, capability and risk.



MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT MODEL

Readiness Dimensions

No.	Decision area	Management evidence	Status
01	Decision inventory	Material choices, frequency, value and friction	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
02	Authority	Accountable owner, delegation and boundaries	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
03	Evidence and criteria	Inputs, standards, options and assumptions	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
04	Forums and cadence	Where and when decisions occur	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
05	Escalation and control	Thresholds, challenge, exceptions and conflicts	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
06	Learning and follow-through	Records, actions, outcomes and review	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**

Evidence Standard

Assessments should distinguish verified evidence from management confidence. Where evidence is incomplete, record the gap, owner, completion date and decision that depends on it.

STRATEGIC READINESS DEPENDENCIES

What Readiness Depends On

Dependency	Why it matters	Evidence management should expect
Decisions	Material recurring choices are identified	Strategy, capital, people, product, risk and operations
Owner	One role has final accountability	Named decision authority and outcome owner
Inputs	Required expertise is defined	Data, finance, customer, technology, people and risk
Criteria	Trade-offs use explicit standards	Value, cost, capacity, risk, reversibility and timing
Forum	The decision is made in the right place	Purpose, membership, quorum and pre-reads
Escalation	Exceptions move predictably	Thresholds, urgency, conflict and deadlock
Record	Rationale and commitments are preserved	Decision, evidence, owner, actions and review
Review	Decision quality improves over time	Outcomes, reversals, delays and lessons

ROALLA Interpretation

Dependencies should be evaluated as a connected system. A weakness in ownership, data, architecture, delivery or governance can change the economics and risk of an otherwise attractive initiative.

SECTION 02

Detailed Readiness Assessment

Convert executive intent into verifiable requirements, accountable evidence and clear remediation actions.



READINESS CHECKLIST

Decision Inventory and Ownership

Completion standard Mark Ready only when the supporting evidence has been verified. Assign an evidence owner to every open item.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
A01	The leadership team has identified the decisions that most affect strategy and execution.	☐	☐	_____
A02	Each material recurring decision has one accountable owner.	☐	☐	_____
A03	Delegated authority includes financial, risk and contractual boundaries.	☐	☐	_____
A04	Consulted roles are limited to people whose input changes decision quality.	☐	☐	_____
A05	The company distinguishes decisions from recommendations, approvals and notifications.	☐	☐	_____
A06	Decision criteria balance value, customer, cost, capacity, risk and reversibility.	☐	☐	_____
A07	Evidence requirements are proportionate to decision significance.	☐	☐	_____
A08	Conflicts between functional and enterprise outcomes have an escalation path.	☐	☐	_____
A09	Founder, board and executive reserved matters are explicit.	☐	☐	_____
A10	Leaders understand where they can decide without seeking permission.	☐	☐	_____

READINESS CHECKLIST CONTINUED

Forums Escalation and Decision Learning

Completion standard Use Gap to create a dated remediation action and identify the management decision that cannot proceed.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
B01	Every executive forum has a defined decision purpose.	☐	☐	_____
B02	Pre-reads present options, evidence, assumptions and a recommended choice.	☐	☐	_____
B03	Meeting time is not consumed by information that can be read asynchronously.	☐	☐	_____
B04	Urgent decisions have a fast path with minimum control requirements.	☐	☐	_____
B05	Deadlocks and cross-functional conflicts have a named escalation authority.	☐	☐	_____
B06	Decision records capture rationale, commitments, owners and review dates.	☐	☐	_____
B07	Actions are tracked to outcome rather than meeting completion.	☐	☐	_____
B08	Reversals distinguish new evidence from unclear initial authority.	☐	☐	_____
B09	Decision speed and quality are reviewed using real examples.	☐	☐	_____
B10	Decision rights are updated when strategy, roles or risk thresholds change.	☐	☐	_____

WEIGHTED EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Readiness Scorecard

Dimension	Weight	Evidence standard	Score	Status
Decision inventory	20%	Material choices, frequency, value and friction	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Authority	20%	Accountable owner, delegation and boundaries	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Evidence and criteria	15%	Inputs, standards, options and assumptions	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Forums and cadence	15%	Where and when decisions occur	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Escalation and control	15%	Thresholds, challenge, exceptions and conflicts	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Learning and follow-through	15%	Records, actions, outcomes and review	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
TOTAL	100%	Weighted executive assessment	__/100	Pursue / Prepare / Monitor

Decision Thresholds

Score	Posture	Management decision
75 to 100	**PURSUE**	Proceed to bounded execution subject to no hard-gate failure.
50 to 74	**PREPARE**	Complete a focused readiness plan before major commitment.
0 to 49	**MONITOR**	Resolve foundational gaps before investing further.

A single material hard-gate failure overrides the weighted score. ROALLA also applies judgment where administrative readiness is high but strategic value, adoption or commercial viability is weak.

SECTION 03

Execution and Advisory Roadmap

Build evidence and decision clarity before changing titles or recruiting. Use the first 90 days to prove the executive decision rights model in the company's real operating context.



Recommended 90 Day Mobilization

Timing	Focus	Key activities	Management output
Days 1 to 15	Clarify	Confirm growth objectives, current executive decision rights model, decision pressure and executive sponsor.	Approved diagnostic mandate
Days 16 to 35	Assess	Interview leaders, review evidence, map accountabilities and identify hard gaps.	Current-state evidence map
Days 36 to 55	Design	Develop practical options with mandate, interfaces, capacity, economics and risk.	Decision-ready options
Days 56 to 75	Validate	Test the preferred model through real decisions, management forums and team feedback.	Validated leadership model
Days 76 to 90	Mobilize	Approve owners, measures, communication, transition actions and review dates.	90-day activation plan

Twelve to Twenty Four Month Path

- Quarter 1: clarify the executive decision rights model, decision rights, interfaces and immediate capacity gaps.
- Quarter 2: embed management cadence, measures, delegation and leadership-team working practices.
- Quarters 3 and 4: adjust spans, roles and succession as scale and complexity increase.
- Year 2: review executive architecture against strategy, performance, risk and the next growth stage.

ROALLA ADVISORY MODEL

How ROALLA Can Help

ROALLA brings an independent transformation and technology perspective to decision rights and accountability design. The objective is a leadership system that converts strategy into accountable decisions, scalable execution and measurable enterprise value.

ROALLA workstream	Executive value
Executive diagnostic	Assess strategy, growth stage, operating complexity, leadership load and material gaps.
Mandate design	Define outcomes, scope, authority, decision rights and explicit non-accountabilities.
Operating model	Align functions, forums, information flows, escalation paths and management cadence.
Technology and product alignment	Connect architecture, delivery, product, commercial and operational leadership.
Role and capacity options	Compare combined, fractional, interim and full-time structures using evidence.
Scorecards and incentives	Translate enterprise priorities into balanced executive outcomes and measures.
Selection and onboarding	Build role briefs, evaluation criteria, interview evidence and first-100-day plans.
Evolution assurance	Monitor effectiveness, challenge gaps and reset roles as strategy and scale change.

Recommended Initial Mandate

- Four-week executive structure and accountability diagnostic.
- Decision-rights map and leadership capacity assessment.
- Recommended executive decision rights model with role mandates, interfaces and transition risks.
- Executive readout and 90-day activation roadmap.

CONTROL FRAMEWORK

Key Risks and Controls

Risk	Exposure	ROALLA control
Shared accountability	Everyone contributes but no one owns the outcome.	Name one final decision owner.
Consensus tax	Consultation becomes veto power.	Separate input from authority.
Executive gravity	Decisions rise higher than necessary.	Delegate with guardrails.
Meeting theatre	Forums discuss but do not decide.	Define purpose and required outputs.
Evidence inconsistency	Choices depend on advocacy rather than standards.	Use explicit criteria and pre-reads.
Escalation surprise	Conflicts become personal or political.	Set thresholds and paths in advance.
Decision amnesia	Reasoning and commitments are lost.	Maintain concise decision records.
Static rights	Authorities no longer fit the organization.	Review after material change.

Professional Advice

Qualified legal, privacy, security, tax, accounting, employment and regulatory advisors should validate matters within their professional scope. ROALLA coordinates those inputs with technology strategy, architecture, commercialization, governance and transformation decisions.

OFFICIAL EVIDENCE BASE

Selected Official Sources

These sources support the management principles summarized in this guide. Standards, laws, guidance and organizational obligations continue to evolve and must be confirmed for the specific context before acting.

Microsoft Cloud Adoption Framework RACI Alignment. Official source — Examples for assigning accountable, responsible, consulted and informed roles across strategy, governance, platforms and operations.

McKinsey The Big Product and Platform Shift. Official source — Research on leadership alignment, business and technology collaboration, talent and transformation execution.

McKinsey Products and Platforms Operating Model. Official source — Guidance on durable product and platform teams, end-to-end ownership, funding and outcome accountability.

Advisory Disclaimer

This ROALLA guide is a strategic readiness and marketing document. It is not a certification, audit opinion, legal opinion, privacy opinion, security assurance, investment recommendation or guarantee of results. Management must validate current obligations, company facts and professional advice before making material decisions.